

The name *unlink* is used instead of *delete* because of the technical detail that it removes the filename linked to the file. But since most files have only one linked filename, this unlinking also deletes the file. It's all right if you don't understand these filesystem concepts; just know that `os.unlink()` deletes a file.

Calling `os.unlink()` permanently deletes the file, which can be dangerous if a bug in your program causes the function to delete the wrong file. Instead, you can use the `send2trash` module's `send2trash()` function to put the file in your operating system's Recycle Bin. To install this module, run `run python -m pip install --user send2trash` from the command prompt on Windows or run `run python3 -m pip install` from the terminal on macOS or Linux. Once the module is installed, you'll be able to import it with `import send2trash`.

Enter the following into the interactive shell:

Python

```
>>> open('deleteme.txt', 'w').close() # Create a blank file.
>>> import send2trash
>>> send2trash.send2trash('deleteme.txt')
```

This example creates a blank file named *deleteme.txt*. After calling `send2trash.send2trash()` (the module and function share the same name), this file is removed to the Recycle Bin.